

SEMANTIC FIELDS

Groups of words linked by the same theme



1 What is it?

Semantic Fields (sih-MAN-tik feelds)

A semantic field is a **group of words** connected to the same topic or theme, used throughout a text to build a consistent idea, atmosphere, or feeling.

multiple words + one shared theme

2 See it in action

War semantic field

Battle, weapon, wound, soldier,
blood — all build a theme of
conflict.

Nature semantic field

Bloom, petal, root, forest,
blossom — all build a theme of
growth.

Darkness semantic field

Shadow, night, black, gloom,
dusk — all build a theme of
darkness.

Money semantic field

Coin, wealth, debt, profit,
poverty — all build a theme of
finance.



You got this!

Try circling every word from one paragraph that seems to belong to the **same "family"** of meaning — that cluster is your semantic field.

FUN FACT

Semantic fields are one of the best tools for exam analysis — spotting one shows examiners you understand how a writer builds meaning across a WHOLE text, not just in one sentence.

3 Why writers use it

Semantic Fields help writers: reinforce a central theme or idea across a whole text without repeating the same word, build a consistent mood or atmosphere, and connect ideas the reader might not consciously notice on a first read.

Spotting a semantic field is a powerful analysis tool — if a writer keeps choosing words from the same "family," it usually reveals what the text is REALLY about, underneath the plot.

4 Where you'll spot it

Newspaper articles

Journalists often build a semantic field of crisis or conflict to shape how a story feels.

Poetry analysis

Examiners love this technique because it shows understanding across a WHOLE poem, not just one line.



Watch out!

A semantic field isn't about repeating ONE word — it's about a **variety** of different words all pointing at the same theme. That variety is what makes it powerful analysis material.



Good spot!

A semantic field often reveals the **real theme** underneath the surface story — ask what idea keeps quietly reappearing through the word choices.

5 Quick recap

Group of linked words

Same underlying theme

Builds mood across a whole text



Keep going!

Practise building your own semantic field — pick a theme like "the sea" and list ten different words that all connect to it.